Your Child Support Assessment

Your reference number: 712 418 500 816
Issue date: 1 April 2025

We have calculated the
annual amount of child support of **$3,536**
payable by **Stephen Cooke** to **Heather Cooke**
for the support of the children in this assessment.

Daily Rate: **$9.68104** Weekly Rate: **$67.77**
Fortnightly Rate: **$135.53** Monthly Rate: **$294.67**

Assessment period: **6 March 2025 to 5 June 2026**

09125/16532 7784/2

DS1:4999015069999984

How your child support is calculated

The amount of child support to be paid is based on a formula that looks at both parents' incomes, how much it costs to raise the children, and the percentage of care each parent provides.

We follow eight steps to calculate child support using a legislative formula - an explanation is below. For more information, go to **servicesaustralia.gov.au/childsupportassessment** and select 'Basic formula'.

Steps 1 to 3: Income

The following income details were used in your assessment:

Stephen		**Heather**
2024 Taxable $8,709	adjusted taxable income	$558,790 2024 Taxable
$29,841	less the self support amount	$29,841
$0	child support income	$528,949
$528,949	combined child support income	$528,949
0.00%	income percentage	100.00%

Adjusted taxable income: the total of taxable income plus other income such as gross reportable fringe benefits total, target foreign income, net investment losses, some tax-free pensions or benefits and reportable superannuation contributions.
Provisional: the income we use when you have not sent your tax return to the Australian Tax Office.
Self-support amount: the amount that is deducted from each parent's adjusted taxable income for their own support. This is a set amount and is the same for each parent.
If the parent s adjusted taxable income is less than the self-support amount, the child support income we use in the assessment will be $0.
Child support income: the income used to calculate child support. This is each parent's adjusted taxable income minus the self-support amount and allowances for relevant dependent children and children from other child support assessments.
Combined child support income: both parents' incomes added together.
Income percentage: each parent's share of the combined child support income.

Steps 4 and 5: Care and cost percentages

We have decided the amount of care you have for Christian and Joshua are based on the care information in our records. The **care percentage** is usually worked out using the number of nights you care for the children.

If you do not tell us about an increase in your care percentage within 28 days, it may not be used in the assessment until the day you do tell us about the change.

If you have 14 per cent or more care of your children a year, we consider that you are directly meeting some of the child's costs through care - this is called the **cost percentage**. When you care for the child you have extra costs for such things as accommodation and food and the cost percentage takes this into account.

Heather

for **Christian**, Heather's care percentage is 100% and her cost percentage is 100%.
for **Joshua**, Heather's care percentage is 100% and her cost percentage is 100%.

Stephen

for **Christian**, Stephen's care percentage is 0% and his cost percentage is 0%.
for **Joshua**, Stephen's care percentage is 0% and his cost percentage is 0%.

Step 6: Child support percentage

Under the formula, we take the cost percentage (share of costs met directly) from the parent's income percentage (share of costs to be met) to get the child support percentage. The child support percentage is applied against the costs of the children (worked out at Step 7) to arrive at the child support amount payable at Step 8.

Step 7: Costs of the children

The costs of children are worked out using both parents' incomes, the number of children and the ages of the children. For your assessment, the costs of the children have been calculated as follows:

Christian born 20 August 2014 (age range: under 13 years, a cost of $21,262)
Joshua born 27 January 2017 (age range: under 13 years, a cost of $21,262)

Where there are children over 13 years of age and under 13 years of age in the assessment, we use the 'children of mixed age' category in the 'cost of children' table. The 'Children of Mixed Age' category is an average of the 0-12 years and 13+ years tables. This means the cost for each child is the same.

Step 8: Child support amount payable

The annual amount of child support that Stephen needs to pay Heather is:
for **Christian** $1,768 A fixed rate of child support has been applied - see note on fixed rate

The annual amount of child support that Stephen needs to pay Heather is:
for **Joshua** $1,768 A fixed rate of child support has been applied - see note on fixed rate

Stephen is required to pay Heather an annual child support amount of $3,536. Heather is required to pay Stephen an annual child support amount of $0.

Final annual Child Support Amount: Stephen is to pay $3,536 to Heather for the support of the children in this assessment.

A fixed rate has been applied to the assessment.
A fixed annual rate of child support per child will be applied when the paying parent has a care percentage of less than 35 per cent and reports a low income but does not receive an income support payment. The fixed rate is indexed annually.

If a parent pays child support for more than three children, the amount payable is capped at three times the fixed rate and shared equally between the children. If you believe your income is genuinely low and it would be unfair for you to pay the fixed rate, you can ask us for a reduction.

For more information go to **servicesaustralia.gov.au/childsupport** or call us on **131 272** (call charges may apply).

Important
The same rules are used to work out your care percentage for child support and family assistance payments. As you receive both payments you only need to contact us once with the details of a change in care and your details will be updated automatically. Your change in care may affect your payments from different dates.

You need to tell us as soon as possible if there are any changes to your circumstances, such as contact details, care details and income. If you do not tell us when they happen, it may result in a debt or an overpayment.

You can tell us by phone, in writing or by going to **my.gov.au** and signing in to access your Child Support online account. If you do not have a myGov account, you can create one and link it to your Child Support account.

Call us if you think this decision is incorrectbecause information was not provided or taken into account; or the legislation has not been applied correctly. We will check the details and explain the decision. You can ask us to review the decision (we call this an objection) within **28 days from the date you receive this letter**. For more information about how to objectgo to our website **servicesaustralia.gov.au/reviewsandappeals**

09125/16533 7784/3 DS1:49990150699984